INCH-POUND

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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

INSIGNIA, EMBROIDERED (COAST GUARD)

This specification is approved for use by the United States Coast Guard, Department of Transportation, and is available for use by all departments and agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for machine and hand embroidered insignia worn on the sleeve of enlisted personnel of the Coast Guard.

1.2 Classification. Embroidered insignia shall be of the following types and classes (see 6.2):

Type I - Rating badge
  Class 1 - Chief Petty Officer
  Class 2 - Petty Officer, First Class
  Class 3 - Petty Officer, Second Class
  Class 4 - Petty Officer, Third Class
  Class 5 - Senior Chief Petty Officer
  Class 6 - Master Chief Petty Officer
  Class 7 - Master Chief Petty Officer of the Coast Guard
Type II - Specialty Mark and Striker Mark
Type III - Group - Rate Mark
  Class 1 - One stripe
  Class 2 - Two stripes
  Class 3 - Three stripes
Type IV - Stripe, Length of Service
Type V - Branch of Service, Shield
Type VI - Insignia, Grade Star

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Officer in Charge, Navy Clothing and Textile Research Facility, Post Office Box 59, Natick, MA 01760-0001 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8455

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

* 2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

* A-A-50199	- Thread, Polyester, Cotton- or Polyester-Covered
* A-A-52094	- Thread, Cotton
PPP-B-676	- Boxes, Setup

MILITARY

MIL-C-823	- Cloth, Serge, Wool, Wool and Nylon, Polyester and Wool
MIL-L-17507	- Lace, Ornamental
MIL-E-17568	- Embroidery Materials, Metallic and Synthetic Metallic
MIL-B-17757	- Box, Shipping, Fiberboard (Modular Sizes)

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191	- Textile Test Methods
FED-STD-751	- Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage
* MIL-STD-2073-1	- DOD Materials Procedures for Development and Application of Packaging Requirements
* MIL-STD-2073-2	- Packaging Requirement Codes

* (Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

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* 2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

U.S. POSTAL MANUAL

(Copies may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001).

* 2.2 Non-Government publications. The following document(s) form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, ATTN: Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036-1404).

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606-5808).

THE COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES

Department of Defense Standard Shades for Sewing Threads

Department of Defense Standard Color Card of Official Standardized Shades For Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons

(Applications for copies should be addressed to The Color Association of the United States, 343 Lexington Avenue, New York, NY 10016-0927).

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide sample. Samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variations from this specification may appear in the sample in which case this specification shall govern.

3.2 First article. When specified the contractor shall furnish sample unit(s) for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3 and 6.2).

3.3 Materials.

3.3.1 Cloth, wool, serge. The serge cloth to be used as a background for embroidered designs shall conform to the requirements of type III, class 3 of MIL-C-823. The color shall match Blue 3362.

3.3.2 Embroidery materials, metallic, and synthetic metallic. The embroidery materials shall conform to the requirements for type I, II, III, Classes 1 thru 6 of MIL-E-17568.

3.3.3 Lace, ornamental. The gold lace used for stripes and chevrons shall conform to the requirements for type II, style A, class 2, 3, 4, or 5, 3/8 inch width, one vellum of MIL-L-17507. The color shall match Gold 3903.

3.3.4 Buckram. The cotton buckram used as backing shall be natural or bleached white, plain weave, and shall have 50 (± 3) picks and ends per inch and the weight shall be 4.8 (± 1.0) ounces per square yard when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.3.4.1 Buckram backing. Unless otherwise specified, buckram backing shall be used to reinforce hand embroidered bullion or synthetic metallic stars, eagle, specialty mark, and shield of rating badge. Sewn on gold lace chevrons and service stripes.

3.3.5 Schiffli - Embroidery yarns.

* 3.3.5.1 Rayon yarn. The rayon face yarn for the white, scarlet, and emerald green shades shall be bright, continuous filament, regenerated cellulose type, 75/3 (±5) denier Schiffli yarn. The yarn for the Port Securityman "PS" capital block letters shall be of 100/2 (±5) denier. Testing shall be as specified in 4.4.1.

*3.3.5.1.1 Colors. The colors of the rayon embroidery yarn shall be as shown below. The use of sulphur dyes is prohibited. The dyed yarn shall show good colorfastness to wet-dry cleaning, bleaching, dry and wet heat (hot pressing), light, and laundering when the end item is tested as specified in 4.4.6. Cable number for the yarn shall be as follows (see 2.2 and 6.2):

White	- Cable No. 67101
Scarlet	- Cable No. 67111
Emerald Green	- Cable No. 67128
Black	- Cable No. 67138

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*3.3.5.1.2 Matching. The dyed yarn shall match the standard sample when viewed under filtered tungsten lamps which approximate artificial daylight having a correlated color temperature of 7500 ± 200 K, with illumination of 100 ± 20 candles, and shall be a good match to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2300 ± 200 K.

3.3.5.1.3 Bobbin thread. The bobbin thread used in Schiffli embroidery shall either be a good commercial grade of two-ply (minimum) undyed cotton thread or a continuous filament undyed (white) nylon thread equal to or better than the quality of the specified cotton thread.

* 3.3.6 Thread, cotton. The white or colored thread used for general stitching operations shall conform to the requirements of A-A-52094 as specified in Table I. In addition, the colored threads shall show good colorfastness to dry and wet heat (hot pressing), when tested as specified in 4.4.1. Unless otherwise specified, the color of the thread shall match the color of the background cloth. As an alternate, the gold thread may conform to type I, ticket number 50 of A-A-50199.

Table I - Threads

Type	Ticket No.		Operations
	Needle	Lower	
I	40	-	Attaching metallic embroidery materials by hand
III	00	00	Hemming and cover stitching (white)
III	00	00	Hemming, attaching gold lace, coverstitching (colors)

3.3.7 Form, fiberboard. When needed, the form used to raise the design of hand embroidered metallic insignia shall be a commercial grade fiberboard of suitable thickness and shall be free of sulphur(see 4.4.1). The face side of the board shall be of a color to approximately match the color of the embroidery material covering it.

3.3.8 Stiffener. When needed, hand embroidered insignia may be treated on the reverse side with a stiffener to facilitate processing or to prevent raveling of the yarn. The stiffener shall not affect the color of the face of the insignia or the background fabric while in storage.

3.3.9 Stitch types and stitches per inch. Stitch types shall conform to FED-STD-751. Stitch type 301 used for hemming shall be 1/8 (± 1/32) inch from the edge. Stitch type 304 used for cover stitching shall be 1/8 (± 1/32) inch wide. Stitches per inch shall be 12 to 14 for general stitching and 45 to 48 for cover stitching.

3.4 Description. The insignia specified in this specification shall be machine embroidered on Schiffli type embroidery machines with rayon yarn in accordance with the applicable Government stitch enlargements (see 3.5.3) or hand embroidered with metallic (bullion) or synthetic metallic embroidery materials in accordance with approved guide samples (see 3.1).

3.4.1 Schiffli construction.

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3.4.1.1 Ground and overlay stitches. The ground and overlay stitches shall be executed in accordance with the applicable stitch enlargement (see 3.5.3) and shall completely cover the prescribed background design area in a closely, densely, and tightly drawn manner to produce a clear, sharp execution of the design with none of the background cloth or underlay stitches visible.

3.4.1.1.1 Chevron (rating badge) and marks (group rate). Stitch execution of chevrons and marks shall be of the ground embroidery type. The number of visible rows shall be as indicated in the applicable stitch enlargement (see 3.5.3). The edges of each chevron and mark shall be finished with a 1/16 inch wide Stiele border stitch (see 3.4.1.3).

3.4.1.2 Underlay stitches. Underlay stitches, where required, shall be inserted in the direction and manner most suitable for proper design execution and shall not be less than the number indicated on the applicable stitch enlargement. The raised areas of the design where underlay is required, shall be equal to the guide sample (see 3.1) in fullness and depth.

3.4.1.3 Stiele border stitches. When required, Stiele border stitches shall be executed in accordance with the applicable stitch enlargement or guide sample (see 3.1 and 3.5.3) and shall be tightly drawn and well executed to produce a clear, sharp border and shall completely cover the background embroidery and cloth.

3.4.2 Hand construction with metallic (bullion) and/or synthetic metallic embroidery materials. When the eagle, stars, specialty marks, and shield are constructed by hand with metallic (bullion) and/or synthetic metallic embroidery materials, the designs shall be produced using component materials specified in 3.3.2, 3.3.4.1, 3.3.7, 3.3.8, and Table II.

3.4.3 Gold lace chevrons and service stripes. Insignia utilizing gold lace shall be produced by combining the background cloth with buckram (see 3.3.4). The gold lace shall be superimposed over the background both in the prescribed manner (see 3.1) and stitched along the sides with thread of color to match the gold lace, using stitch type 301. The ends of the gold lace shall fit into slits cut into the background cloth and the entire length of slits completely coverstitched with stitch type 304, using thread to match the color of the background cloth.

3.4.4 Finishing. Unless otherwise specified, all insignia shall have all outer edges of the background cloth hemmed with a 3/8 to 1/2 inch turn under, using stitch type 301 and seam type EFa-1. The color of the thread shall match the background cloth.

3.4.5 Spacing. All insignia covered by this specification shall be centered on the background fabric.

3.5 Color combination and design.

3.5.1 Color combination. The color combination of the insignia shall be in accordance with Table II as indicated by the color combination code letter.

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3.5.2 Design.

3.5.2.1 Schiffli embroidered. Stitch enlargements shall be furnished by the Government to the contractor for use in preparing the necessary punchings. The stitch enlargments shall not be altered in any way. All punchings shall be approved by the Government for conformity to requirements for minimum number of stitches as specified for the applicable insignia in Table III prior to start of production.

3.5.2.2 Hand embroidered. The design of the hand metallic or synthetic metallic embroidered and/or gold lace insignia shall be in accordance with the Government approved guide sample and shall not be altered in any way (see Table IV).

3.5.2.3 Direction of design. Background fabrics having a twill effect in their weave shall have the height dimension of the embroidered design finishing in the length (warp) direction of the fabric.

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Table II - Color and Material for Design

Color Combination Code Letter	Background Cloth	Rating Badge			
		Eagle	Specialty Mark	Chevrons	Stars
CG-06 (E10)	Blue Serge	Silver Bullion or Syn Met	Gold Bullion or Syn Met	Gold Syn Lace	Gold Bullion or Syn Met
CG-01 (E7-E9)	Blue Serge	Silver Bullion or Syn Met	Silver Bullion or Syn Met	Gold Syn Lace	Silver Bullion or Syn Met
CG-02 (E4-E6)	Blue Serge	White	White	Scarlet	N/A
CG-03	Blue Serge	N/A	White	N/A	N/A
CG-04	Blue Serge	N/A	White	N/A	N/A
CG-05	Blue Serge	N/A	White	N/A	N/A

Table II (cont'd)

Color Combination Code Letter	Background Cloth	Type of Design			
		Striker Mark Specialty	Group Rate	Service Stripe	Shield
CG-06 (E10)	Blue Serge	N/A	N/A	Gold Syn Lace	Gold Bullion or Syn Met
CG-01 (E7-E9)	Blue Serge	N/A	N/A	Gold Syn Lace	Gold Bullion or Syn Met
CG-02 (E4-E6)	Blue Serge	N/A	N/A	Scarlet	Gold Bullion or Syn Met
CG-03	Blue Serge	White	White	N/A	Gold Bullion or Syn Met
CG-04	Blue Serge	White	Scarlet	N/A	Gold Bullion or Syn Met
CG-05	Blue Serge	White	Emerald Green	N/A	Gold Bullion or Syn Met

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3.5.3 Construction requirements. Construction requirements and dimensions for Schiffli and hand embroidered insignia shall be as specified in Tables III and IV.

Table III - Stitch Requirements

Type and class	Minimum No. of stitches	2/ Design and dimensions	Finished sizes (inches)	Stitch enlargement drawing No. 3/
Type I, class 2, Petty Officer, First Class	6980 1/	figure 5	4 x 5-7/8	16-1-372
Type I, class 3, Petty Officer, Second Class	6268 1/	figure 6	4 x 5-1/8	16-1-372
Type I, class 4, Petty Officer, Third Class	5556 1/	figure 7	4 x 4-3/8	16-1-372
Type II, Specialty Mark or Striker Mark				
Aviation Electrician's Mate	895	figure 8	2-7/8 x 1-7/8	16-1-286
Technician	825	figure 8	2-7/8 x 1-7/8	16-1-208
Aviation Machinist's Mate	960	figure 8	2-7/8 x 1-7/8	16-1-288
Aviation Structural Mechanic	910	figure 8	2-7/8 x 1-7/8	16-1-291
Aviation Survivalman	1439	figure 8	2-7/8 x 1-7/8	16-1-135
Boatswains Mate	580	figure 8	2 x 2	16-1-293
Damage Controlman	405	figure 8	2 x 2	16-1-442
Data Processing Techician	550	figure 8	2 x 2	16-1-24
Dental Technician	755	figure 8	2 x 2	16-1-301
Electrician's Mate	1280	figure 8	2 x 2	16-1-204
Electronics Technician	450	figure 9	2 x 2	16-1-221
Machinery Technician	690	figure 9	2 x 2	16-1-303
Fire Control Technician	540	figure 9	2 x 2	16-1-306
Fire Fighter	1243	figure 9	2 x 2	16-1-590
Gunner's Mate	515	figure 9	2 x 2	16-1-307
Hospital Corpsman	685	figure 9	2 x 2	16-1-203
* Investigator	884	figure 9	2 x 2	16-1-614
Marine Science Technician	615	figure 9	2 x 2	16-1-134
Musician	510	figure 9	2 x 2	16-1-317
Photo Journalist	594	figure 10	2 x 2	16-1-443
* Port Securityman	1026 4/	figure 10	2 x 2	16-1-624
Quartermaster	590	figure 10	2 x 2	16-1-323
Radarman	410	figure 10	2 x 2	16-1-324
Radioman	625	figure 10	2 x 2	16-1-325
Sonar Technician	525	figure 10	2 x 2	16-1-528
Storekeeper	550	figure 10	2 x 2	16-1-332
Subsistence Specialist	641	figure 10	2 x 2	16-1-444
Telephone Technician	1160	figure 11	2 x 2	16-1-308
Yeoman	300	figure 11	2 x 2	16-1-210

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Table III - Stitch Requirements (cont'd)

Type and class	Minimum No. of stitches	2/ Design and dimensions	Finished sizes (inches)	Stitch enlargement drawing No. 3/
Type III, Group-Rate Mark				
Class 1-One stripe	890	figure 12	3-1/8 x 2-5/16	16-1-15
Class 2-Two stripes	1780	figure 12	3-1/8 x 2-15/16	16-1-15
Class 3-Three stripes	2670	figure 13	3-1/8 x 3-1/2	16-1-15
Type IV, Stripe, Length of Service (Scarlet)				
One stripe	2247	figure 14	6 x 7/8	16-1-447
Two stripes	4494	figure 14	6 x 1-1/2	16-1-447
Three stripes	6741	figure 14	6 x 2-1/8	16-1-447
Four stripes	8988	figure 14	6 x 2-3/4	16-1-447
Five stripes	11235	figure 14	6 x 3-3/8	16-1-447
Six stripes	13482	figure 14	6 x 4	16-1-447
Seven stripes	15729	figure 14	6 x 4-5/8	16-1-447

1/ Exclusive of the number of stitches for the speciality mark.
2/ Figures 5 thru 11 are for dimensions only and are not drawn to scale. For correct design and proper stitch execution refer to the applicable stitch enlargement. Unless otherwise specified, all dimensions are in inches.
3/ MIL-I-87097 is hereby added as additional reference on drawing.
4/ Of the 1026 stitches, 775 are for the shield design and 251 stitches are for the two letters PS.

Table IV - Requirements for hand embroidered insignia

Type and Class	1/ Design and dimensions	Finished size (inches)
Type I,		
Class 1, Chief Petty Officer	figure 4	4 x 5-7/8
Class 5, Senior Chief Petty Officer	figure 3	4 x 7-1/4
Class 6, Master Chief Petty Officer	figure 2	4 x 7-1/4
Class 7, Master Chief Petty Officer of the CG	figure 1	4 x 7-1/4
Type IV, Stripe, Length of service (Gold Lace)		
One stripe	figure 14	6 x 7/8
Two stripes	figure 14	6 x 1-1/2
Three stripes	figure 14	6 x 2-1/8
Four stripes	figure 14	6 x 2-3/4
Five stripes	figure 14	6 x 3-3/8
Six stripes	figure 14	6 x 4
Seven stripes	figure 14	6 x 4-5/8

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Table IV - Requirements for hand embroidered insignia(cont'd)

Type and Class	1/ Design and dimensions	Finished size (inches)
Type V, Shield, Branch of Service	figure 15	13/16 x 1
Type VI, Insignia, Grade, Star	figure 15	3/4 diameter

1/ Figures 1, 2, 3, 4, 14, and 15 are for dimensions only and are not drawn to scale.

3.6 Type I, Rating badge.

3.6.1 Construction (machine embroidered Schiffli). Type I, classes 2, 3, and 4 rating badges shall be embroidered on the background cloth specified in Table II in accordance with the applicable stitch enlargement listed in Table III, the dimensions specified in the applicable figure, and the construction requirements of 3.4.1.

3.6.2 Construction (Hand embroidered). Type I, classes 1, 5, 6, and 7 rating badges shall be embroidered on the background cloth specified in Table II in accordance with the approved guide sample, the dimensions specified in the applicable figure, and the construction requirements of 3.4.2 and Table IV.

3.6.3 Type II - Specialty Marks and Striker Mark. The specialty mark shall be centered on the rating badge between the upper chevron and the eagle's talons. Striker mark shall be centered on the background cloth specified in Table II and shall be embroidered in accordance with the designs and dimensions indicated for specialty marks and striker marks in figures 8 thru 11. Construction shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of 3.6.1 or 3.6.2.

3.6.4 Type III - Group Rate Mark. The group rate marks shall consist of one (class 1) stripe, two (class 2) stripes, or three (class 3) stripes embroidered diagonally on the background cloth specified in Table II. The stripes shall be machine embroidered in accordance with the applicable stitch enlargement listed in Table III, the dimensions specified in figures 12 and 13, the construction requirements of 3.4.1.

3.6.5 Type IV - Stripe, Length of Service. Insignia shall consist of one thru seven stripes, as applicable, stitched diagonally on the background cloth specified in Table II. The gold lace stripes shall be cut to meet the dimensions specified in figure 14, and the construction requirements of 3.4.3.

3.6.6 Type V - Insignia, Branch of Service, Shield. The shield shall be hand embroidered with 13 simulated stars at top one-third of shield, arranged in two horizontal rows, 7 stars over 6 stars. The bottom two-thirds of shield shall have 12 or 13 vertical stripes. Shield shall be hand embroidered on the background cloth specified in Table II and in accordance with the approved guide sample, the dimensions specified in figure 15, and the construction requirements of 3.4.2 and 3.6.2.

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3.6.7 Type VI - Insignia, grade, star. The star(s) shall be of a five point design in accordance with the dimensions specified in figure 15. Star(s) shall be hand embroidered in accordance with 3.4.2 and 3.6.2.

3.7 Measurement tolerances. The tolerances listed in Table V shall be applicable to specified dimensions for finished insignia.

Table V - Tolerances

Inches		Tolerances
Dimensions	under 15/16	± 1/32
Dimensions ranging -	from 1 to 1-15/16	± 1/16
	from 2 to 2-15/16	± 3/32
	from 3 to 3-15/16	± 1/8
	from 4 to 4-15/16	± 5/32
	from 5 to 5-15/16	± 3/16
	from 6 to 6-15/16	± 7/32
	from 7 to 7-15/16	± 1/4
Degrees for angle of chevrons		± 3

3.8 Workmanship. The finished insignia shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. The occurence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

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4.1.2 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

* 4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

1. First article inspection (see 4.3).
2. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

* 4.3 First article inspection. When required, the first article submitted in accordance with 3.2 shall be inspected as specified in 4.4.2 for compliance with design, construction, workmanship and dimensional requirements.

* 4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable procurement documents. Components listed in Table II shall be tested using methods specified in FED-STD-191, wherever applicable. The lot shall be unacceptable if the average of one or more sample units fail to meet the requirements specified. The sample size for each component shall be as follows:

Lot Size	Sample Size (Units)
800 or less	2
801 thru 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

The lot size and sample unit shall be expressed as follows:

Component	Lot Size Expressed as	Sample Unit for Component Testing
Buckram	Yards	1 linear yard
Embroidery yarn (each type)	Holders	1 cone spool or sufficient number of bobbins to total 360 yards
Thread (all types and sizes)	Holders	1 cone or spool or sufficient number of bobbins to total 360 yards

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Table VI - Component Testing

Component	Characteristic	Requirements Paragraph	Test Method	Determinations Per Sample Unit	Results Reported as
Buckram	Material Ident.	3.3.4	1/	1	Pass/fail
	Weave	3.3.4	Visual	1	Pass/fail
	Yarn per inch				
	Ends	3.3.4	5050	5	Pass/fail
	Picks	3.3.4	5050	5	Pass/fail
	Weight	3.3.4	5041	5	Pass/fail
Rayon Embroidery yarn	Material ident.	3.3.5.1	1/	1	Pass/fail
	Denier	3.3.5.1	4021	1	Pass/fail
	Ply	3.3.5.1	Visual	1	Pass/fail
	Presence of sulphur	3.3.5.1.1	2020 1/	1	Pass/fail
Bobbin Yarn	Material Ident.	3.3.5.1.3	1/	1	Pass/fail
	Ply	3.3.5.1.3	Visual	1	Pass/fail
Thread, cotton	Colorfastness to: Dry heat (hot pressing)	3.3.6	5640	1	Pass/fail
	Wet heat (hot pressing)	3.3.6	5640	1	Pass/fail
Fiberboard form	Presence of sulfur	3.3.7	2020 1/	1	Pass/fail

1/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for this requirement.

4.4.2 Examination of the end item. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with 4.4.2.1 through 4.4.2.2. The sample unit shall be one finished insignia. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one insignia. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) shall be as specified in 4.4.3.

4.4.2.1 Visual examination. The finished insignia shall be examined for defects in design, material, construction, and workmanship and classified in accordance with the defects listed in Table VII.

* 4.4.2.2 Dimensional examination. The finished insignia shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any measurement deviating from specified dimensions on applicable figure and in Table III shall be scored as a defect.

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Table VII - Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
I. Material (Gold Lace and background cloth)	(a) Other than specified (b) Color or shade other than specified (c) Hole, float, slub, knot, broken, spot or stain
II. Design	(a) Any deviation from applicable stitch enlargement, drawing, illustration or guide sample. (b) Wrong color or color arrangement. (c) Design poorly defined, distorted or misshaped. (d) Design not properly positioned and/or centered. (e) Form board used to raise design missing (when applicable)
III. Construction	(a) Any operation omitted or not performed as specified. (b) Distortion of surface yarns (face), loose or tight tension. (c) Traveling stitches on face side (walking or jumping) (d) Broken, missing or skipped stitches, any (e) Bobbin thread visible on face (f) Stiele stitching omitted (g) Unrelated colors or yarn visible on face (h) Uneven spacing between service stripes or chevrons (i) Stitching incomplete (j) Edges of design or patch not finished as specified (k) Wrong stitch type (l) Width of Stiele border stitch not 1/16 inch (m) Stitches not of sufficient closeness or density (n) Stitches not drawn tight enough (o) Embroidered on wrong side of background cloth (p) Incomplete coverage, background cloth or underlay stitches visible (q) Open or poorly formed points in gold lace

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Table VII - Classification of defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defects
III. Construction (cont'd)	(r) Buckram omitted, incomplete, or extending beyond insignia
	(s) Height dimension of embroidered design not finished in length direction of (when applicable) background cloth having a twill effect in its weave
IV. Finish stitching and attachment	(a) Stitches per inch not within specified range
	(b) Tight or loose tension affecting appearance
	(c) Irregular or uneven gauged stitching, affecting appearance
	(d) Broken or skipped stitches more than 1/4 inch in length
	(e) Color or hemming thread not as specified
	(f) Ends not fitted into slits cut in background cloth (i.e., gold lace chevrons and service stripes)
	(g) Points not mitered (i.e., gold lace chevrons)
	(h) Edges not finished as required
	(i) Wrong stitch type or seam type
	(j) Run off, any
	(k) Stitch tension, stitch density, or stitch bight not uniform
	(l) Partially obscuring design
	(m) Edges of base cloth showing through
	(n) Finished edges irregular or wavy
IV. Workmanship	(a) Spot, stain or foreign matter on face
	(b) Two or more thread ends or stumps longer than 1/16 inch
	(c) Creased or folded, will not flatten with manual pressure
	(d) Bunched, kinked or tangled yarns on face
	(e) Shifted or scuffed surface yarns
	(f) Color of insignia face affected by stiffener coating

4.4.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed as defects per 100 units for the visual and dimensional examinations shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL
For visual examination in 4.4.2.1	II	4.0
For dimensional examination in 4.4.2.2	S-3	6.5

* 4.4.4 Examination of packaging requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking comply with Section 5 requirements of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be on the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

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Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, inadequate stapling, bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of items per shipping container or bundle is more or less than required. Number of set-up boxes per shipping container more or less than specified. 1/

1/ For this defect, one item from each shipping container in sample shall be examined.

4.4.5 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested as specified in Table VIII. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one insignia of each type or class. The unit of product for tests shall be six insignia. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet requirements referenced in Table VIII. The sample size shall be as follows:

Lot Size (each)	Sample Size
800 or less	2
801 thru 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

Table VIII - End Item Tests

Characteristics	Requirement Paragraph	Test Method	No. Determinations Per Unit of Product	Results Reported as
Rayon Yarns				
Shade match	3.3.5.1.2	Visual	1 each color	Pass or Fail
Colorfastness to: 1/		2/		
Bleaching	3.3.5.1.1	5600	1	Pass or Fail
Light	3.3.5.1.1	5660	1	Pass or Fail
Wet-dry cleaning	3.3.5.1.1	5622	1	Pass or Fail
Laundering	3.3.5.1.1	5614	1	Pass or Fail
Wet and Dry Heat (hot pressing)	3.3.5.1.1	5640	1	Pass or Fail
Base cloth (type)	3.3.1	Visual	1	Pass or Fail

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1/ Test reports shall be furnished for each color of yarn used in the initial shipping lot of finished insignia. A contractor's certificate of compliance will be accepted for each color for each subsequent lot of insignia on the same contract provided the contractor certifies that the dyer or dye formulation has not been changed.
2/ Except that the test specimens shall be the finished embroidered insignia.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Quantity per set-up box.

5.1.1.1.1 Type I - Badge, Rating - all classes. Each rating badge shall be individually preserved in a snug fitting, flat style polyethylene bag that conforms to the requirements specified in 5.1.1.2. The bag opening shall be across the width of the bag face. The open end of the bag shall be folded over. Twenty (20) rating badges of one class only shall be preserved in a set-up box that conforms to the requirements specified in 5.1.1.3.1.

5.1.1.1.2 Type II and III - Specialty Mark and Striker mark and Group Rate Marks. Ten (10) marks, of one kind only, shall be preserved in a snug fitting, flat style polyethylene bag that conforms to the requirements specified in 5.1.1.2. The bag opening shall be across the width of the bag face. The open end of the bag shall be folded over. Sixty (60) marks (6 bags of 10 each), of one kind only shall be preserved in a set-up box that conforms to the requirements specified in 5.1.1.3.1.

5.1.1.1.3 Type IV - Stripe, length of service. Service stripes of one size only shall be put up in bundles of 30 each and securely held together with string or elastic bands. Insignia put up as shown below shall be preserved in a set-up box that conforms to the requirements of 5.1.1.3.1.

6 or 7 stripes	- 1 bundle of 30	(30)
4 or 5 stripes	- 2 bundles of 30 each	(60)
3 stripes	- 3 bundles of 30 each	(90)
2 stripes	- 5 bundles of 30 each	(150)
1 stripe	- 8 bundles of 30 each	(240)

5.1.1.1.4 Type V - Insignia, Branch of Service, Shield. Five (5) insignia shall be preserved in a snug fitting, flat style polyethylene bag that conforms to the requirements specified in 5.1.1.2. The bag opening shall be across the width of the bag face. The open end of the bag shall be folded over. Sixty (60) insignia (12 bags of 5 each), shall be preserved in a set-up box that conforms to the requirements specified in 5.1.1.3.1.

5.1.1.1.5 Type VI - Insignia, Grade, Star. The insignia shall be preserved in accordance with the industry's practice.

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5.1.1.2 Bags, polyethylene. The polyethylene bags shall be fabricated from clear polyethylene film of 0.0010 inch thickness (±20% tolerance). The polyethylene bags shall be formed with heat-sealed seams that are straight, continuous, and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag.

5.1.1.3 Boxes, set-up.

5.1.1.3.1 Types I, II, III, V, and VI Insignia. Insignia of one type and kind only, preserved as specified, shall be placed in a two piece telescope style, set-up paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. The outside dimensions of the set-up box shall be 7 inches in length, 5 inches in width and 2 1/8 inches in depth. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the interior of the set-up boxes containing wool or part wool items shall be sprinkled with not less than 1/4 ounce of flaked naphthalene.

5.1.1.3.2 Type IV Insignia. Insignia of one kind only, preserved as specified, shall be placed in a two piece telescope style, set-up paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. The outside dimensions of the set-up box shall be 11-1/2 inches in length, 7-5/8 inches in width and 2 3/8 inches in depth. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the interior of the set-up boxes containing wool or part wool items shall be sprinkled with not less than 1/4 ounce of flaked naphthalene.

5.1.2 Commercial. The insignia shall be preserved to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the contractor to the first receiving activity. The package and quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the contractor for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Types I, II, III, V, and VI Insignia. Fifteen (15) set-up boxes of one type, class and kind only, preserved as specifed in 5.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container assembled, closed and reinforced conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c, size 1 of MIL-B-17757. Each shipping container shall be waterproofed in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.1.2 Type IV Insignia. Six (6) set-up boxes packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container assembled, closed and reinforced conforming to type CF, class weather resistant, variety DW, grade V15c, size 1 of MIL-B-17757. Each shipping container shall be waterproofed in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Types I, II, III, V, and VI Insignia. Fifteen (15) set-up boxes of one type, class and kind only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container assembled, closed and reinforced conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 200, size 1 of MIL-B-17757.

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5.2.2.2 Type IV Insignia. Six (6) set-up boxes packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container assembled, closed and reinforced conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 200, size 1 of MIL-B-17757.

5.2.3 Level C. Item packaged, as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that normally used by the contractor for retail distribution. Containers shall comply with the US Postal Service Manual, Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

* 5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, unit packs, and intermediate or exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

* 5.4 MIL-STD-2073. When specified (see 6.2), Preservation and Packing shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-2073-1 and MIL-STD-2073-2.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

* 6.1 Intended use. The items are intended for wear by Coast Guard enlisted personnel to specify rate, specialty, grade, apprenticeship and length of service.

* 6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type, class and color combination required (see 1.2, 3.3.5.1 and 3.5).
c. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
d. When first article inspection is required (see 3.2), the item will be tested and should be a first article sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examination, quantity and testing and approval.
e. Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
f. When all packaging data is to be found in MIL-STD-2073-1 and MIL-STD-2073-2 (see 5.4).

6.3 Samples and patterns. For access to samples and patterns, address the procuring activity issuing the invitation for bids (see 3.1 and 3.5).

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* 6.4 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

* 6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.
Badge, rating
Mark, rate, group
Mark, specialty and striker
Schiffli
Stripe, service

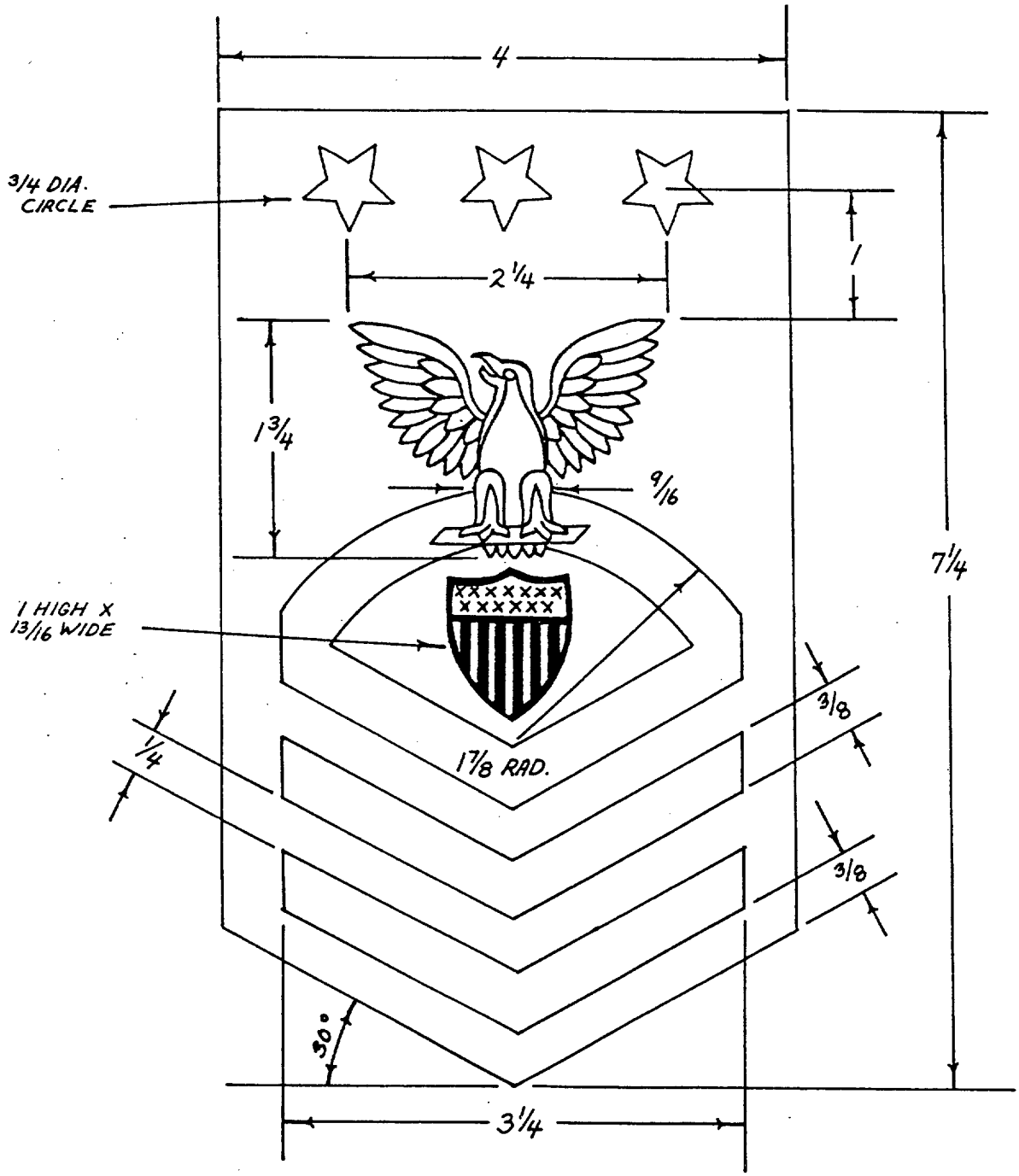
Custodian:
Coast Guard - CG

Preparing Activity:
Navy - NU

Review activity:
DLA - CT

Project 8455-0553

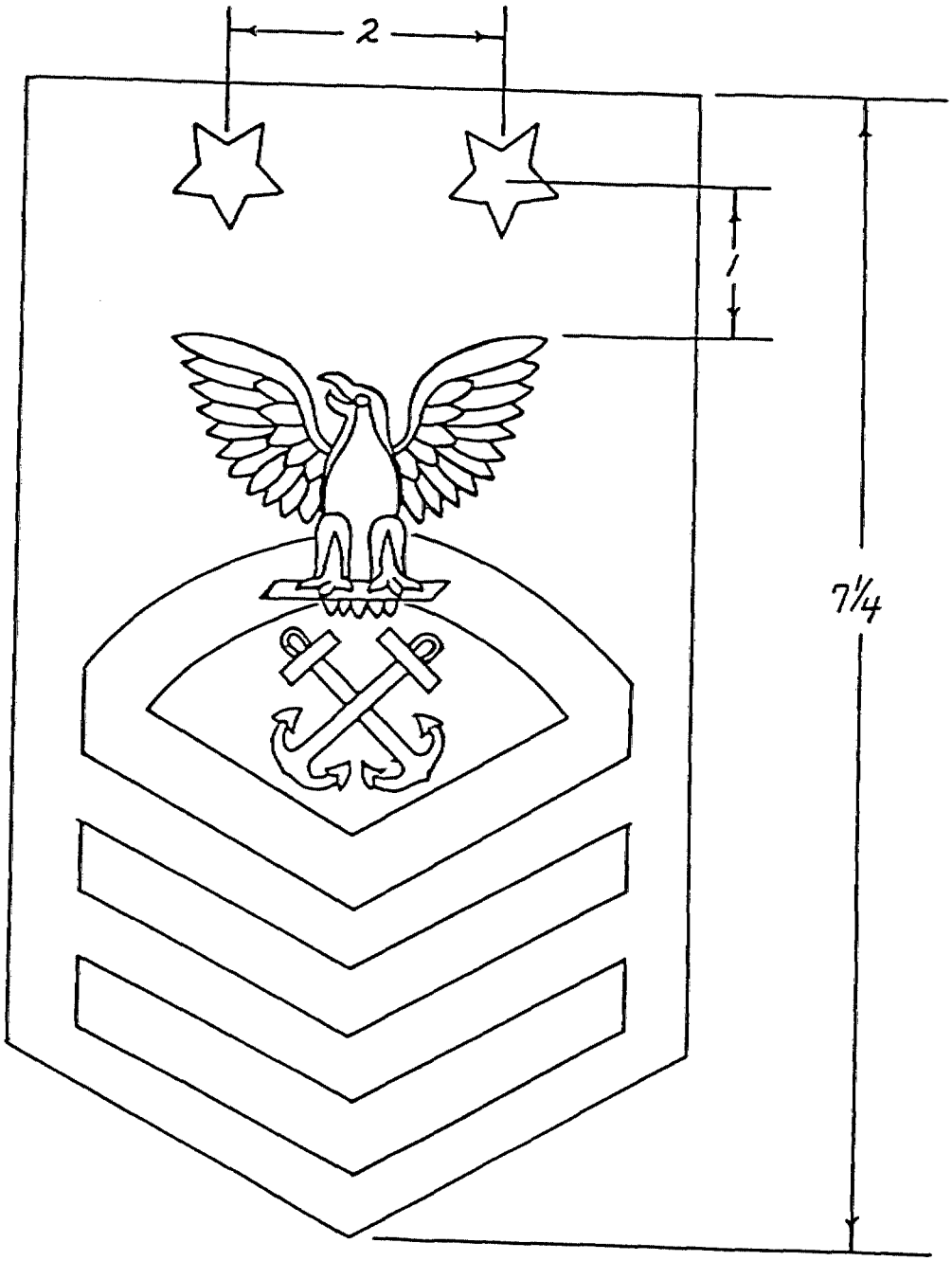
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Figure 1 - Rating Badge, Master Chief Petty Officer of the Coast Guard

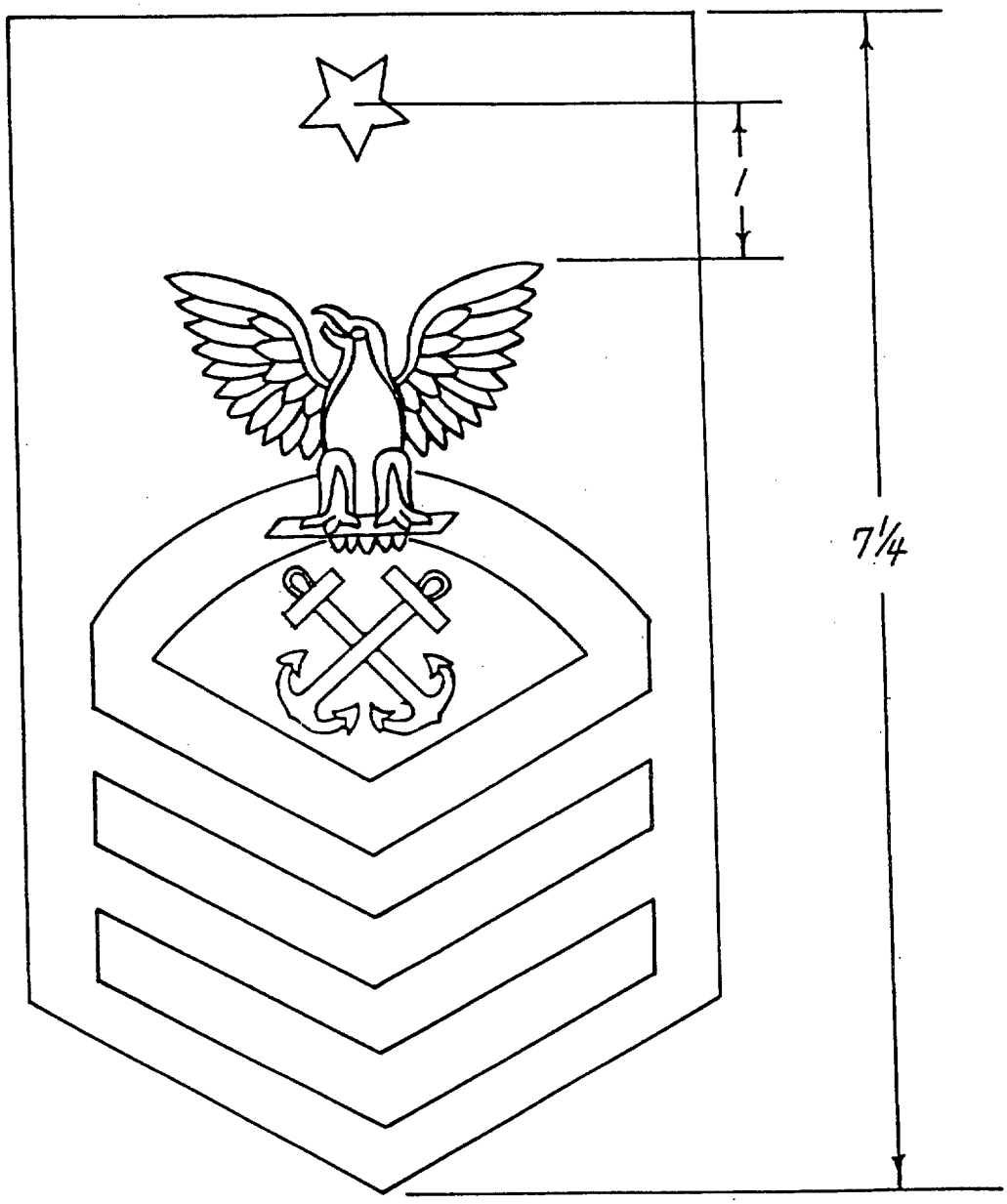
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Figure 2 - Rating Badge, Master Chief Petty Officer

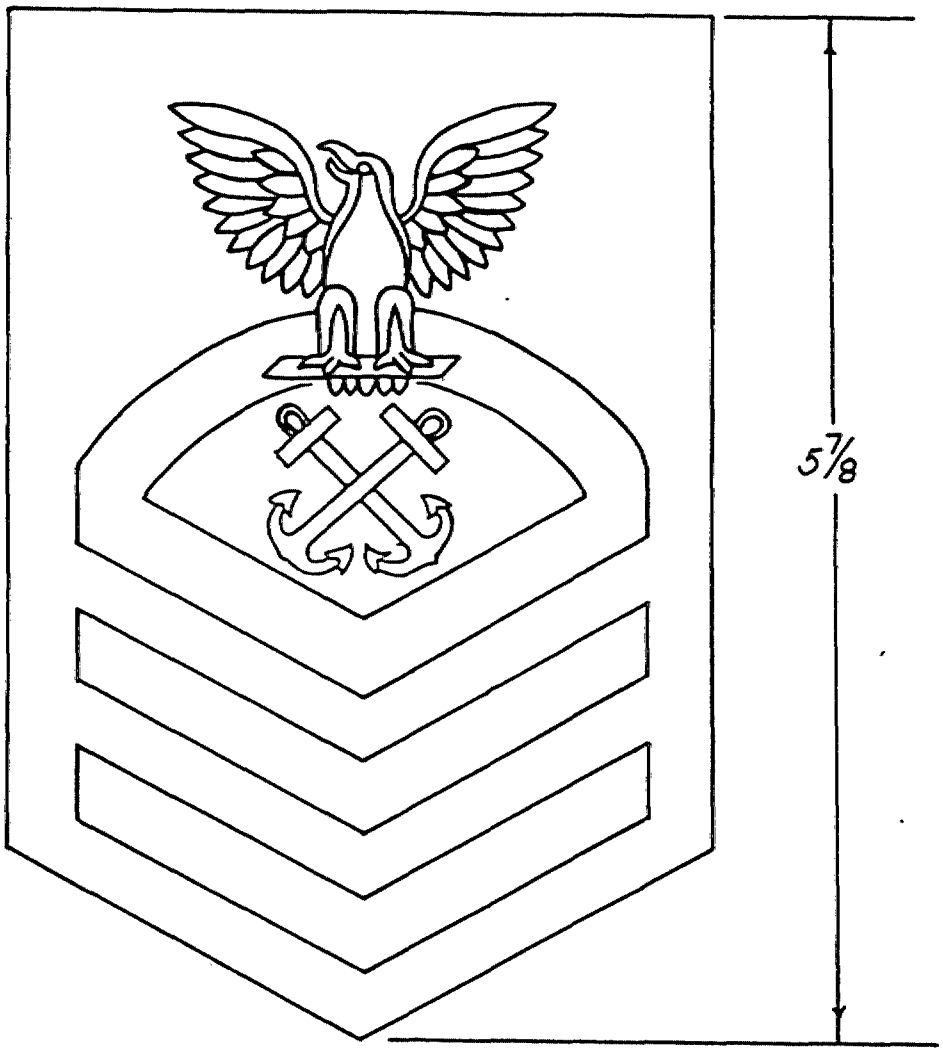
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Figure 3 - Rating Badge, Senior Chief Petty Officer

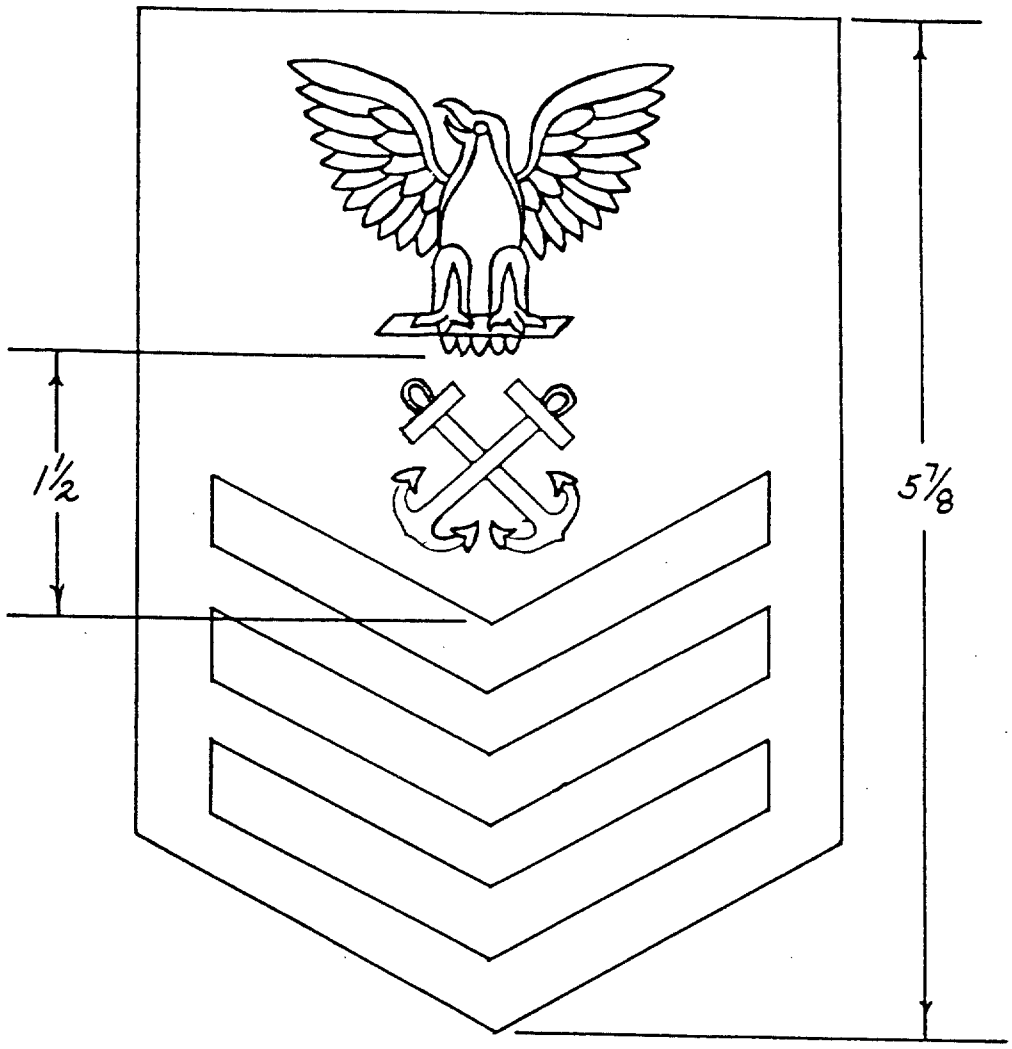
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Figure 4 - Rating Badge, Chief Petty Officer

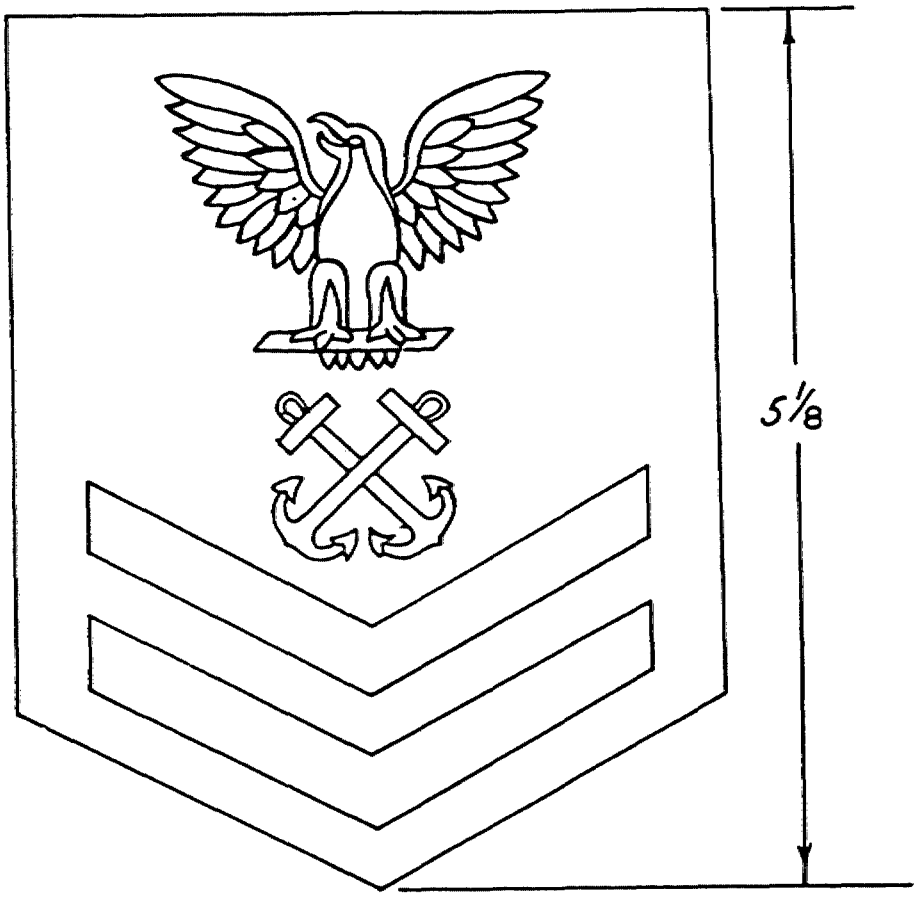
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Figure 5 - Rating Badge, Petty Officer, First Class

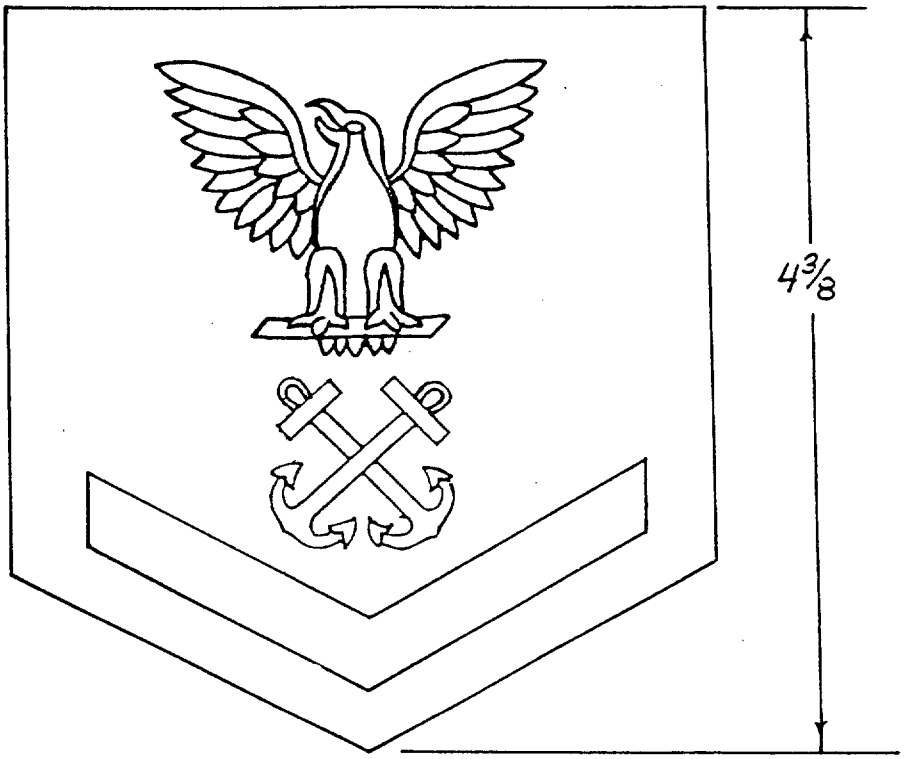
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Figure 6 - Rating Badge, Petty Officer, Second Class

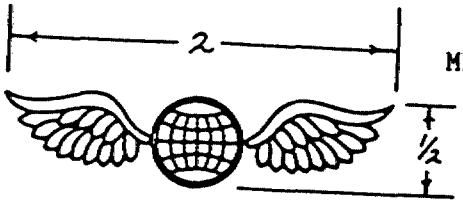
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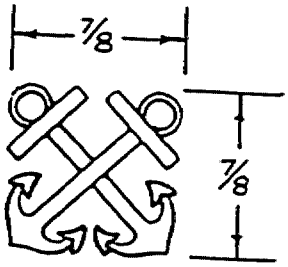
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Figure 7 - Rating Badge, Petty Officer, Third Class

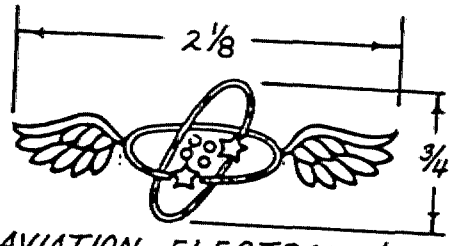
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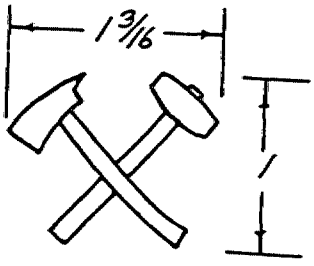
AVIATION ELECTRICIAN'S MATE (AE)



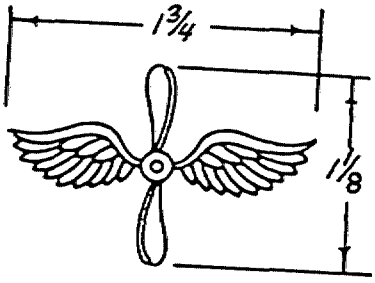
BOATSWAIN'S MATE (BM)



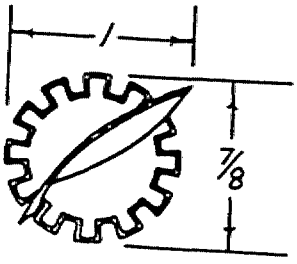
AVIATION ELECTRONIC'S TECHNICIAN (AT)



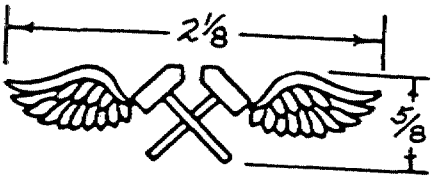
DAMAGE CONTROLMAN (DC)



AVIATION MACHINIST'S MATE (AD)



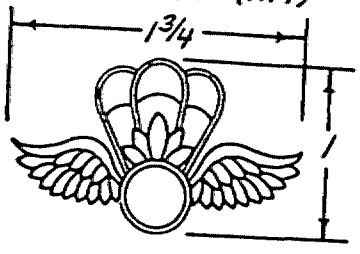
DATA PROCESSING TECHNICIAN (DP)



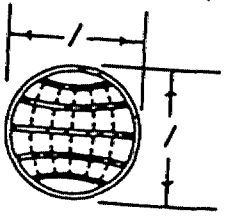
AVIATION STRUCTURAL MECHANIC (AM)



DENTAL TECHNICIAN (DT)



AVIATION SURVIVALMAN (ASM)



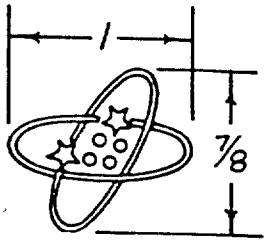
ELECTRICIAN'S MATE (EM)

* NOT APPLICABLE TO RATING BADGES

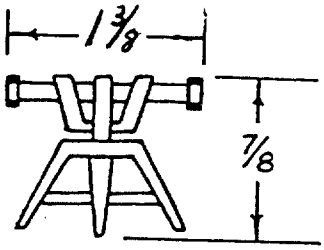
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Figure 8 - Specialty Mark And Striker Mark

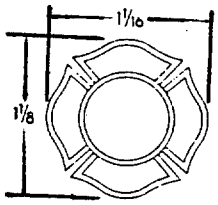
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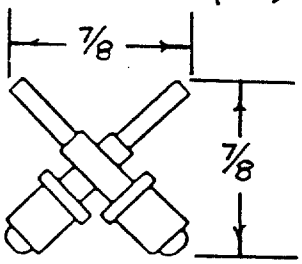
ELECTRONIC'S TECHNICIAN (ET)



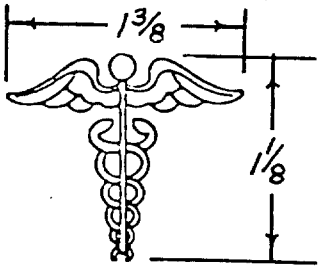
FIRE CONTROL TECHNICIAN (FT)



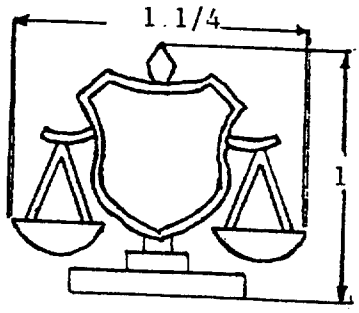
FIRE FIGHTER (FI)



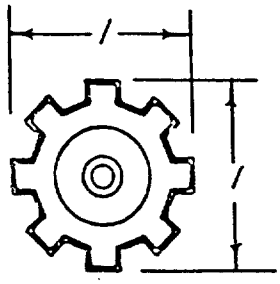
GUNNER'S MATE (GM)



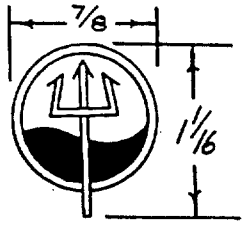
HOSPITAL CORPSMAN (HM)



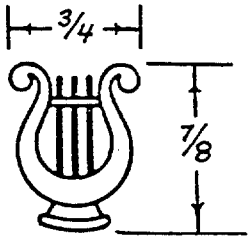
Investigator (IV)



MACHINERY TECHNICIAN (MK)



MARINE SCIENCE TECHNICIAN (MST)

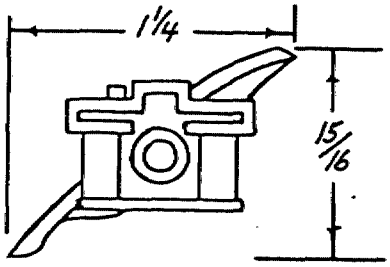


MUSICIAN (MU)

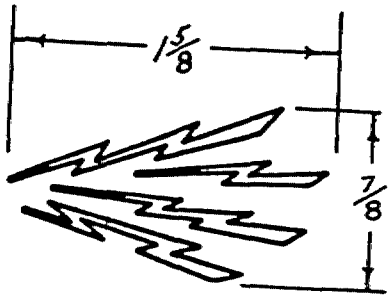
NOTE: ILLUSTRATION IS FOR DIMENSIONS ONLY. FOR CORRECT DESIGN AND PROPER STITCH EXECUTION REFER TO THE APPLICABLE STITCH ENLARGEMENT. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED, ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES.

Figure 9 - Specialty Mark And Striker Mark

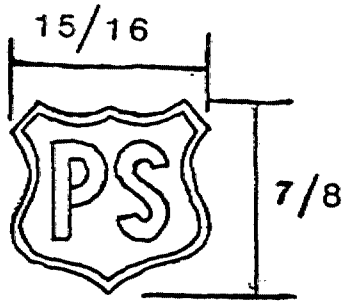
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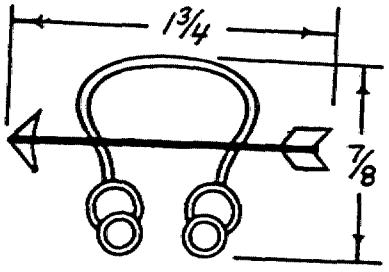
PHOTOJOURNALIST (PA)



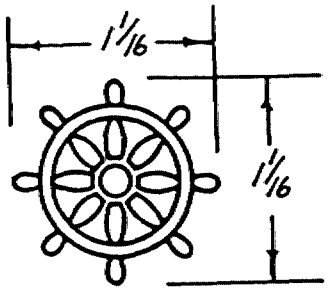
RADIOMAN (RM)



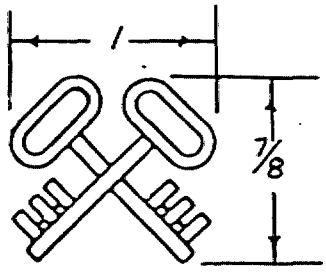
PORT SECURITYMAN(PS)



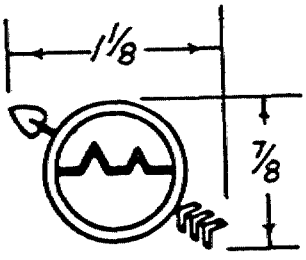
SONAR TECHNICIAN (ST)



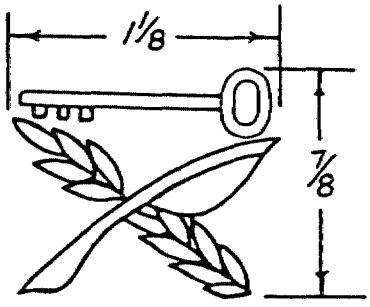
QUARTERMASTER (QM)



STOREKEEPER (SK)



RADARMAN (RD)

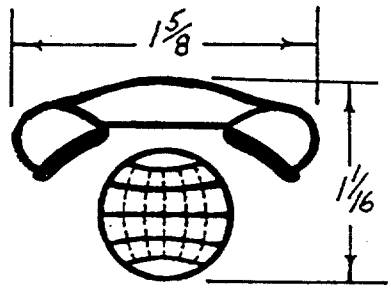


SUBSISTENCE SPECIALIST (SS)

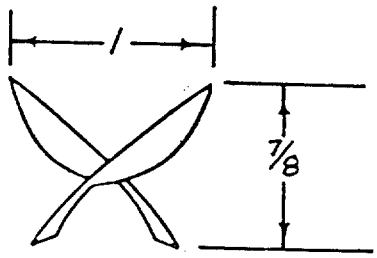
NOTE: ILLUSTRATION IS FOR DIMENSIONS ONLY. FOR CORRECT DESIGN AND PROPER STITCH EXECUTION REFER TO THE APPLICABLE STITCH ENLARGEMENT. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED, ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES.

Figure 10 - Specialty Mark And Striker Mark

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TELEPHONE TECHNICIAN (TT)

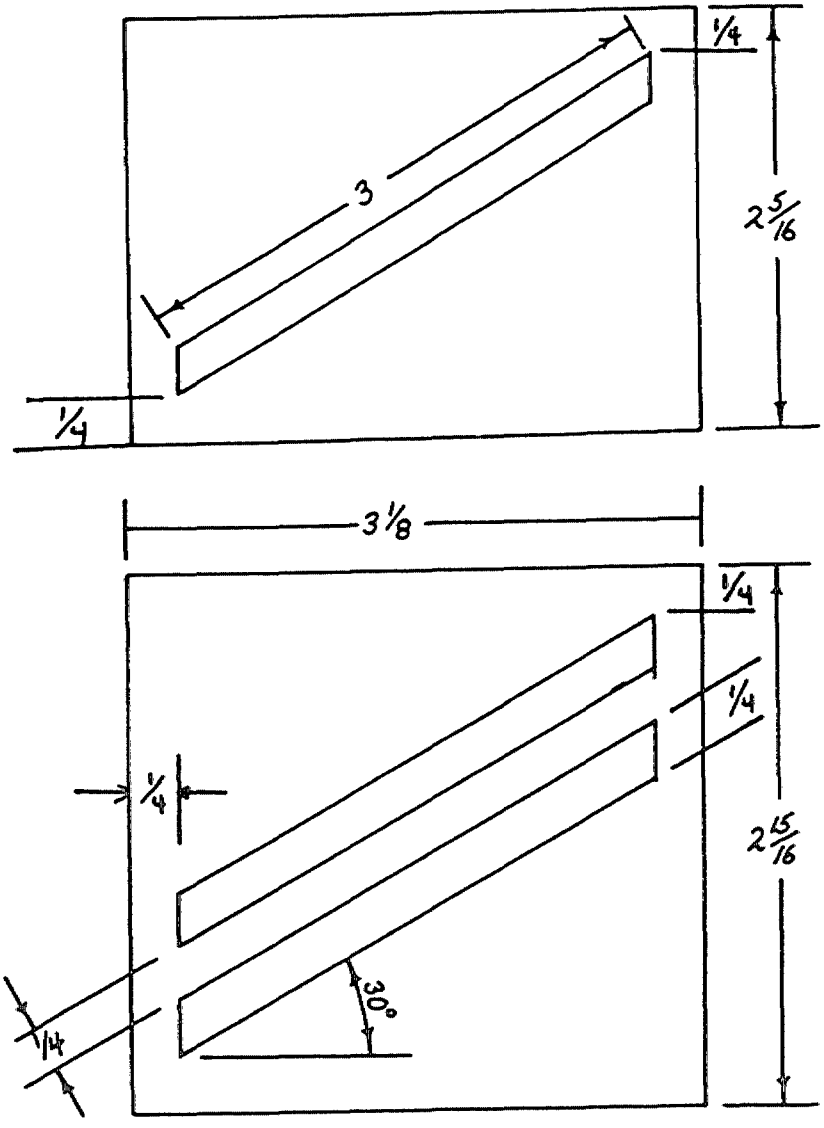


YEOMAN (YN)

NOTE: ILLUSTRATION IS FOR DIMENSIONS ONLY. FOR CORRECT DESIGN AND PROPER STITCH EXECUTION REFER TO THE APPLICABLE STITCH ENLARGEMENT. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED, ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES.

Figure 11 - Specialty Mark And Striker Mark

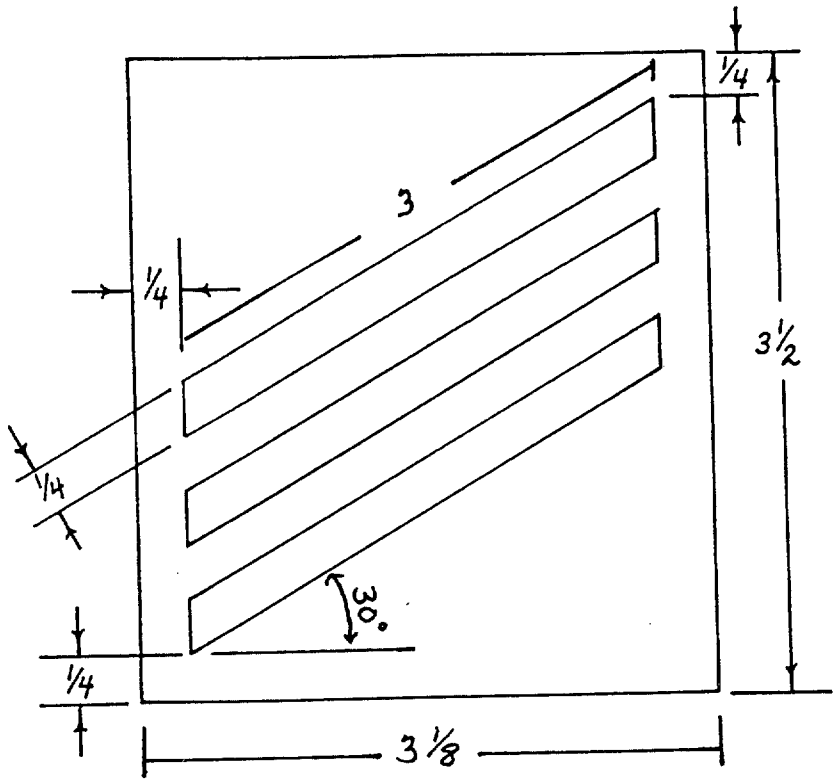
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:53Z
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NOTE: ILLUSTRATION IS FOR DIMENSIONS ONLY. FOR CORRECT DESIGN AND PROPER STITCH EXECUTION REFER TO THE APPLICABLE STITCH ENLARGEMENT. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED, ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES.

Figure 12 - Group-Rate Marks

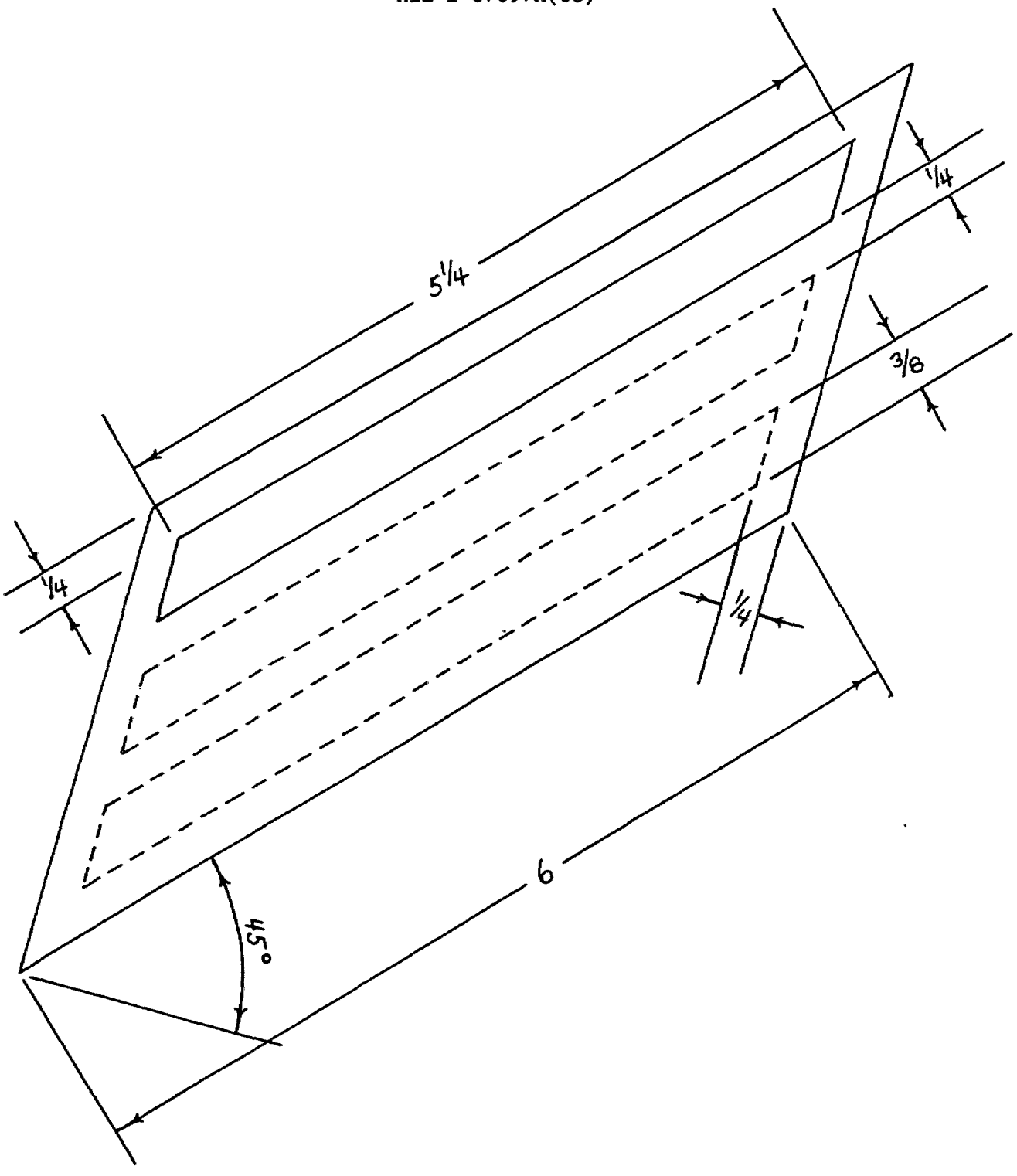
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T04:53Z
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NOTE: ILLUSTRATION IS FOR DIMENSIONS ONLY. FOR CORRECT DESIGN AND PROPER STITCH EXECUTION REFER TO THE APPLICABLE STITCH ENLARGEMENT. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED, ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES.

Figure 13 - Group Rate Mark

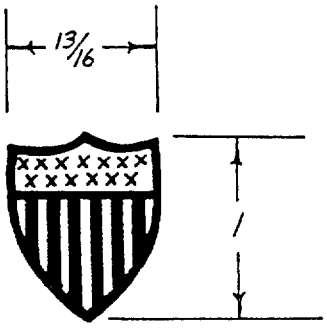
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NOTE: ILLUSTRATION IS FOR DIMENSIONS ONLY. FOR CORRECT DESIGN AND PROPER STITCH EXECUTION REFER TO THE APPLICABLE STITCH ENLARGEMENT. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED, ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES.

Figure 14 - Stripe, Length of Service

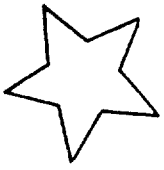
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Shield

Branch of Service

(Size of the background patch shall be a 2 inch square)



Insignia, Grade, Star
(3/4 inch Diameter)

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Figure 15 - Shield and Star

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